

Local installation without docker

Download and install node.js

Download the Windows installer for Node.js (LTS recommended, version 20.19 – 24.x) from the official site and run it: **<https://nodejs.org/>**

(choose the “Windows Installer” MSI)

After installation, open a new PowerShell or Command Prompt and verify:

`node -v` # should report v20.19.x or higher

`npm -v` (or `npm.cmd -v` for window user) # should report a version $\geq 8.x$ (or using **`npm.cmd -v`** if it fails)

n8n requires Node.js ≥ 20.19 and $\leq 24.x$

Install n8n with npm

`npm install n8n -g` (or **`sudo npm install n8n -g`** for mac users)

(or **`npm.cmd install n8n -g`**)

In your PowerShell (no need for sudo on Windows), run:

Enable local file access

`$env:N8N_RESTRICT_FILE_ACCESS_TO = "C:\temp "`

Or

`$env:N8N_RESTRICT_FILE_ACCESS_TO = ""`

Launch n8n

`n8n` # or equivalently: `n8n start` (or **`n8n.cmd start`**)

1. Access n8n with browser

Open your browser to:

<http://localhost:5678>

Remark:

In case you find that the error of PowerShell blocking the npm.ps1 stub because it isn't signed. You have a few easy ways to work around it:

```
npm.cmd -v
```

```
n8n.cmd start
```

Install n8n with docker

Download docker

Go to: <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>

Download and install **Docker Desktop** for Windows

You may need to install wsl and refer to the followings:

Run: wsl --install (for fresh install) or wsl --update (to update).

(This may require a restart. It will download and set up a Linux distribution (e.g., Ubuntu) automatically.)

After installation → start Docker Desktop

Accept the license and let it finish initialization

Make sure the Docker whale icon in the system tray is running (green)

Install n8n image

Create the folder

```
mkdir C:\n8n-docker
```

```
cd C:\n8n-docker
```

Prepare for the docker compose file

```
notepad compose.yaml
```

Sample Docker compose file (Copy lines below)

```

services:
  n8n:
    image: docker.n8n.io/n8nio/n8n:latest
    restart: unless-stopped
    ports:
      - "5678:5678"
    environment:
      # Timezone for Hong Kong
      - GENERIC_TIMEZONE=Asia/Hong_Kong
      - TZ=Asia/Hong_Kong

      # Security & general settings
      - N8N_ENFORCE_SETTINGS_FILE_PERMISSIONS=true

      # Task runners - external mode
      - N8N_RUNNERS_ENABLED=true
      - N8N_RUNNERS_MODE=external
      - N8N_RUNNERS_BROKER_LISTEN_ADDRESS=0.0.0.0
      - N8N_RUNNERS_AUTH_TOKEN=super-secure-random-secret-1234567890abcdef # - CHANGE THIS to your own strong secret

      # Enable native Python support
      - N8N_NATIVE_PYTHON_RUNNER=true

      # File access - allow your mounted C:/temp folder
      - N8N_RESTRICT_FILE_ACCESS_TO=/temp:/home/node/.n8n-files

      # Store binary data on disk (recommended when working with files)
      - N8N_DEFAULT_BINARY_DATA_MODE=filesystem

      # Optional: longer task request timeout (in seconds)
      - N8N_RUNNERS_TASK_REQUEST_TIMEOUT=180

    volumes:
      - n8n_data:/home/node/.n8n
      - C:/temp:/temp

  runners:
    image: n8nio/runners:latest
    restart: unless-stopped
    environment:
      # Connect to the n8n service by name (most reliable in compose)
      - N8N_RUNNERS_TASK_BROKER_URI=http://n8n:5679

      # Must be EXACTLY the same as in n8n service
      - N8N_RUNNERS_AUTH_TOKEN=super-secure-random-secret-1234567890abcdef # - CHANGE THIS to match above

      # More verbose logging to help debug connection/registration issues
      - N8N_RUNNERS_LAUNCHER_LOG_LEVEL=debug

      # Keep runners alive longer when idle (seconds; 0 = never shutdown)
      - N8N_RUNNERS_AUTO_SHUTDOWN_TIMEOUT=300

    depends_on:
      - n8n

volumes:
  n8n_data:

```

Activate the docker with the compose file

docker compose up -d

Or you could shut down the docker

docker compose down